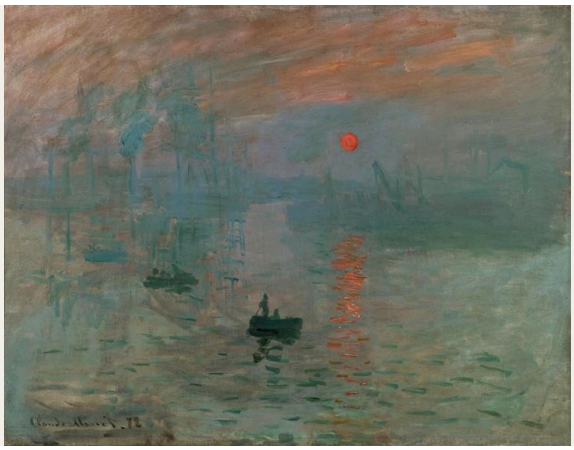
PARIS, FRANCE

Musée Marmottan Monet: Masterpieces

Twenty works on the balance between a recognisable subject and the marks, light and reflections that unsettle it.



The harbour in *Impression, Sunrise* is identifiable despite its blurred distance. An orange disc and a few dark boats do work that a more detailed picture might distribute across dozens of objects. Elsewhere at the Marmottan, steam interrupts a station's ironwork and reflections complicate the edges of Monet's garden.

This selection follows the relation between firm structure and uncertain boundaries, but does not belong to Monet alone. Morisot lets garden light continue through a family group; Renoir organises a reader around a bright sheet of paper; an earlier studio scene assembles many students around one model. The twenty works offer several answers to what painting needs to describe clearly—and what it can leave less settled.

Artline selected these works from documented museum holdings. The selection is independent of the museum, and individual works may be on loan or off display. Dates and attributions retain the qualifications in the linked records.

Explore this selection in Artline

See the selected works alongside books and events from their period, or compare when the artists lived. The books and events provide context, not evidence of direct influence. Works without confirmed dates remain in this guide.

Artworks in context Who lived when?

artlines.org/guides/marmottan-monet

The selection · 20

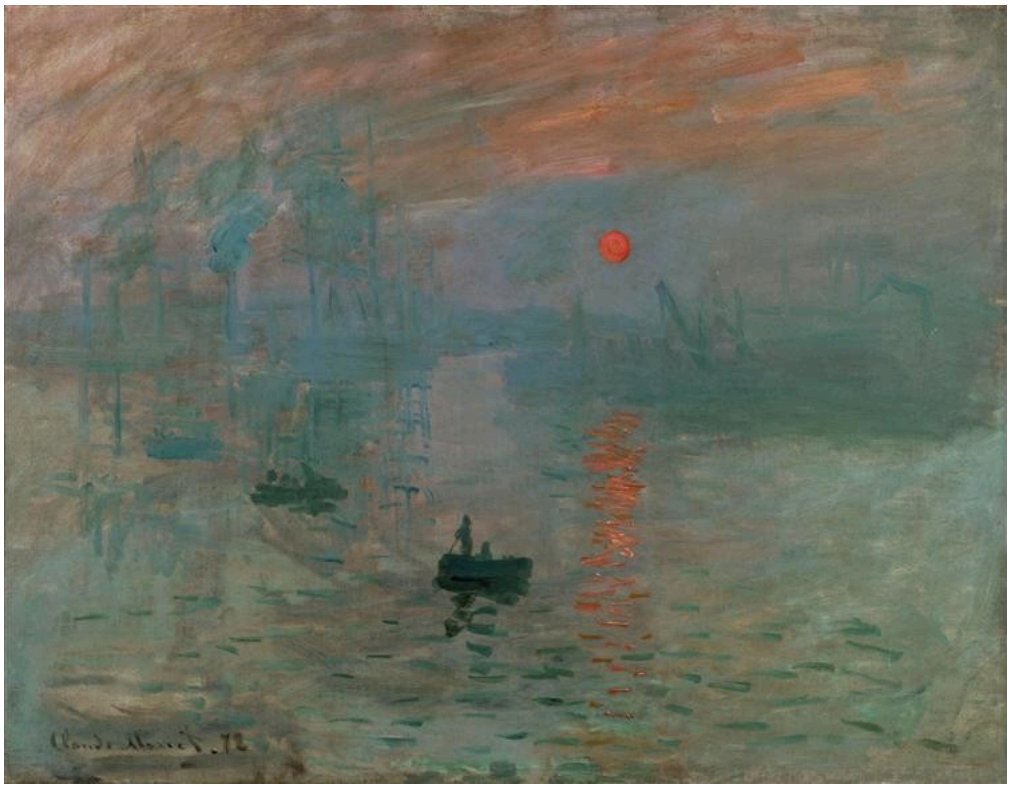
1. Impression, Sunrise
   Claude Monet · 1872
2. Boats under Construction
   Berthe Morisot · 1874
3. Eugène Manet and His Daughter at Bougival
   Berthe Morisot · c. 1881
4. Shepherdess Resting
   Berthe Morisot · 1891
5. Water-Lily Pond
   Claude Monet · 1918–1919
6. Boats in the Port of Honfleur
   Claude Monet · 1917
7. Bouquet of Flowers
   Paul Gauguin · 1897
8. Claude Monet Reading
   Pierre-Auguste Renoir · c. 1873
9. Interior of Gros's Studio
   Auguste Antoine Massé · 1824
10. The Arno Valley from the Paradisino at Vallombrosa
    Louis Gauffier · 1799
11. The Outer Boulevards, Snow Effect
    Camille Pissarro · 1879
12. Berthe Morisot Reclining
    Édouard Manet · 1873
13. Portrait of Julie Manet
    Pierre-Auguste Renoir · 1894
14. Mademoiselle Victorine de Bellio
    Pierre-Auguste Renoir · 1892
15. Spring near Paris: Apple Trees in Blossom
    Alfred Sisley · 1879
16. Volterra: Road Descending from the Town
    Jean-Baptiste-Camille Corot · c. 1834
17. Indian Summer near Moret-sur-Loing
    Alfred Sisley · 1891
18. At the Ball
    Berthe Morisot · 1875
19. The Pont de l'Europe, Gare Saint-Lazare
    Claude Monet · 1877
20. Arm of the Seine near Giverny, Sunrise
    Claude Monet · 1897

01 / 20

Impression, Sunrise

Claude Monet

1872 · Musée Marmottan Monet



Claude Monet. Impression, sunrise. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The orange sun stays distinct while much of Le Havre's harbour loses its edges in vapour. Dark boats and short reflections provide enough structure to locate the water. Shown in 1874, the painting's title supplied Louis Leroy with the word he used to mock the exhibitors. The historical label grew from this particular way of withholding detail.

Object source · Open artwork

02 / 20

Boats under Construction

Berthe Morisot

1874 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Berthe Morisot. Boats under Construction. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/berthe-morisot/boats-under-construction · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

The unfinished hulls reveal the structures that a completed boat normally covers. Rigging and supports add diagonals across the shoreline, giving the harbour a working rather than exclusively scenic character. Morisot makes construction visible through these exposed relations; the boats are recognisable even before they have acquired their finished surfaces.

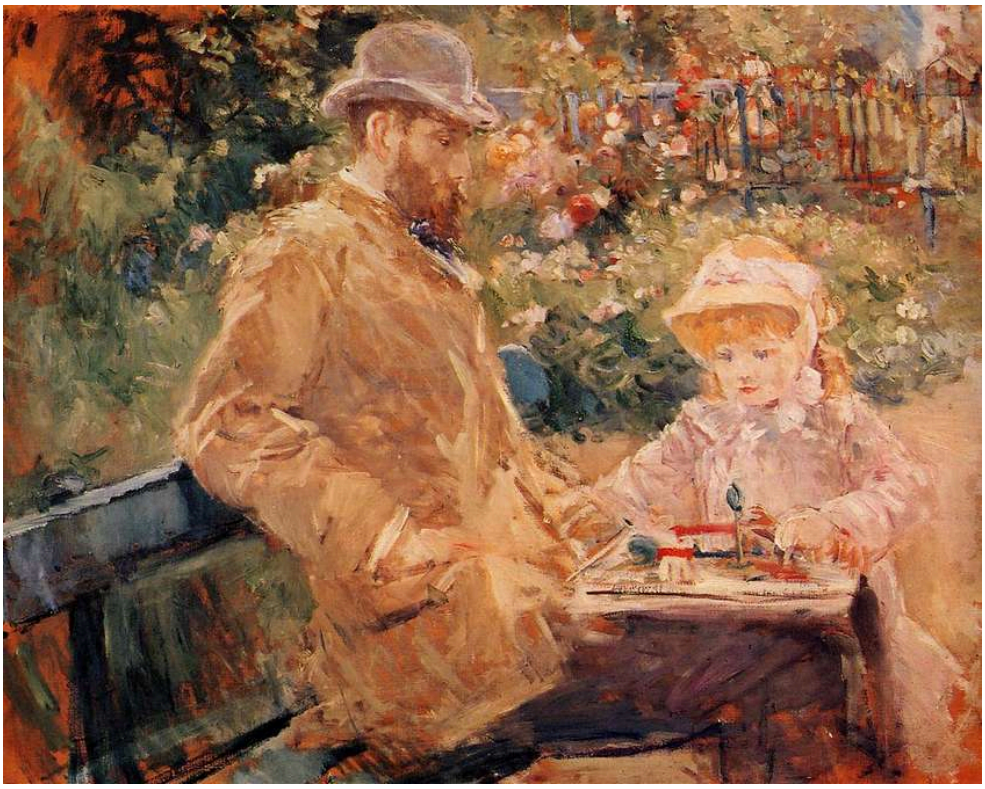
Object source · Open artwork

03 / 20

Eugène Manet and His Daughter at Bougival

Berthe Morisot

c. 1881 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Berthe Morisot. Eugene Manet with his daughter at Bougival. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/berthe-morisot/eugene-manet-with-his-daughter-at-bougival · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

Father and daughter share a small area around the garden table while bright foliage continues behind them. The closely spaced marks pass through clothes and vegetation, making the family group part of the same light as its surroundings. Their activity organises the portrait without requiring either person to turn outward in a formal presentation.

Object source · Open artwork

04 / 20

Shepherdess Resting

Berthe Morisot

1891 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Berthe Morisot. Shepherdess Resting. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/berthe-morisot/shepherdess-resting-1891 · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

The long skirt carries the reclining body into the greens and browns of the ground. One arm supports the head, identifying rest through a simple physical arrangement. The figure remains distinguishable even where the surrounding marks are similar, so the relationship between body and grass can soften without becoming a loss of form.

Object source · Open artwork

05 / 20

Water-Lily Pond

Claude Monet

1918–1919 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Claude Monet. Bassin aux nymphéas. Image credit: Claude Monet; https://www.marmottan.fr/notice/5105/?is=true. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:BASSIN_AUX_NYMPH%C3%89AS_(1918-1919)_Claude_Monet_-_Mus%C3%A9e_Marmottan_Monet_(W_1882).jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The division between bank and water is repeatedly disturbed by reflections and dense strokes of colour. Red, green and pale marks occupy the same active surface. The garden remains identifiable, but recognition is continually renewed rather than secured by one clear horizon or outline. The painting makes that difficulty part of sustained looking.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 5105

06 / 20

Boats in the Port of Honfleur

Claude Monet

1917 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Claude Monet. Bateaux dans le port de Honfleur. Image credit: Claude Monet; https://www.marmottan.fr/notice/5022/?is=true. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Bateaux_dans_le_port_de_Honfleur,_Esquisse_(1917)_Monet_-_Mus%C3%A9e_Marmottan_Monet_-_W1846.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

Masts and the church spire divide the low sky above the boats and waterfront houses. Their narrow verticals give detail to a view otherwise arranged in broad bands. The museum catalogue dates this work to 1917; that recorded date should not be silently replaced by an earlier year inferred from expectations about Monet's harbour painting.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 5022

07 / 20

Bouquet of Flowers

Paul Gauguin

1897 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Paul Gauguin. Bouquet de fleurs. Image credit: Paul Gauguin; musée Marmottan-Monet [1]. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Paul_Gauguin_-_Bouquet_de_fleurs_-_Mus%C3%A9e_Marmottan-Monet.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The bouquet forms a compact upper mass, while the vase, cloth and fruit provide a less crowded base. Red and blue flowers give the arrangement weight through colour rather than individually isolated botanical detail. The balance between those two densities keeps the still life from becoming equally busy across its whole surface.

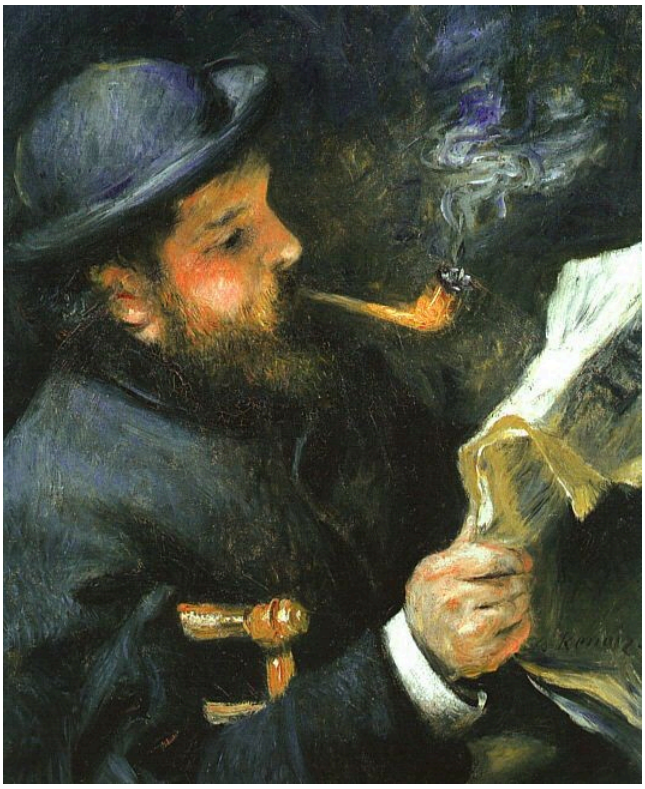
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 5333

08 / 20

Claude Monet Reading

Pierre-Auguste Renoir

c. 1873 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Pierre-Auguste Renoir. Claude Monet lisant. Image credit: Pierre-Auguste Renoir; Source credit: Own work , user:Rlbberlin. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Proportional resize and JPEG compression; full source frame retained. · Public domain

The paper catches light close to Monet's hands while his hat partly encloses the face. Renoir presents a painter absorbed in reading, with no need for a palette to identify a professional role. The portrait's activity turns inward toward the sheet, making the sitter's attention available without demanding his reciprocal gaze.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 5013

09 / 20

Interior of Gros's Studio

Auguste Antoine Massé

1824 · Musée Marmottan Monet



Auguste Antoine Massé. Intérieur de l'atelier de Gros. Image credit: Auguste-Antoine Massé. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

Many students look toward one seated model, their easels and raised hands occupying different parts of the high room. The model's separation explains the studio's collective organisation. What appears crowded is also purposeful: several acts of study depend on the same visible body, seen from positions that cannot all provide the same view.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 1591

10 / 20

The Arno Valley from the Paradisino at Vallombrosa

Louis Gauffier

1799 · Musée Marmottan Monet



Louis Gauffier. La vallée de l'Arno vue depuis le Paradisino de Vallombrosa. Image credit: Louis Gauffier. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The terrace wall separates the figures' immediate place from the broad valley beyond. That boundary gives the landscape a vantage point, making its extensive distance something viewed from somewhere particular. Gardens, woods and hills can then recede on a scale different from the small group standing near the foreground edge.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 20

11 / 20

The Outer Boulevards, Snow Effect

Camille Pissarro

1879 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Camille Pissarro. Les boulevards extérieurs. Effet de neige.. Image credit: Camille Pissarro; musée Marmottan-Monet [1]. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Camille_Pissarro_-_Les_boulevards_ext%C3%A9rieurs,_effet_de_neige_-_Mus%C3%A9e_Marmottan-Monet.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

Snow softens buildings and traffic without bringing the boulevard to a halt. People and carriages remain active among bare trees, their darker marks held within a restricted range of pale tones. Weather alters the city's visibility while leaving its use recognisable, a balance different from a landscape emptied of daily movement.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 4021

12 / 20

Berthe Morisot Reclining

Édouard Manet

1873 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Édouard Manet. Portrait de Berthe Morisot étendue. Image credit: Édouard Manet; Source credit: Unknown source Unknown source. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Proportional resize and JPEG compression; full source frame retained. · Public domain

The pale face appears within a larger dark mass of clothes, hair and hat, set against red. That economy makes small changes around the eyes and mouth especially consequential. The portrait gains its presence through a few strong relations rather than through an extensive setting or a detailed account of the sitter's occupation.

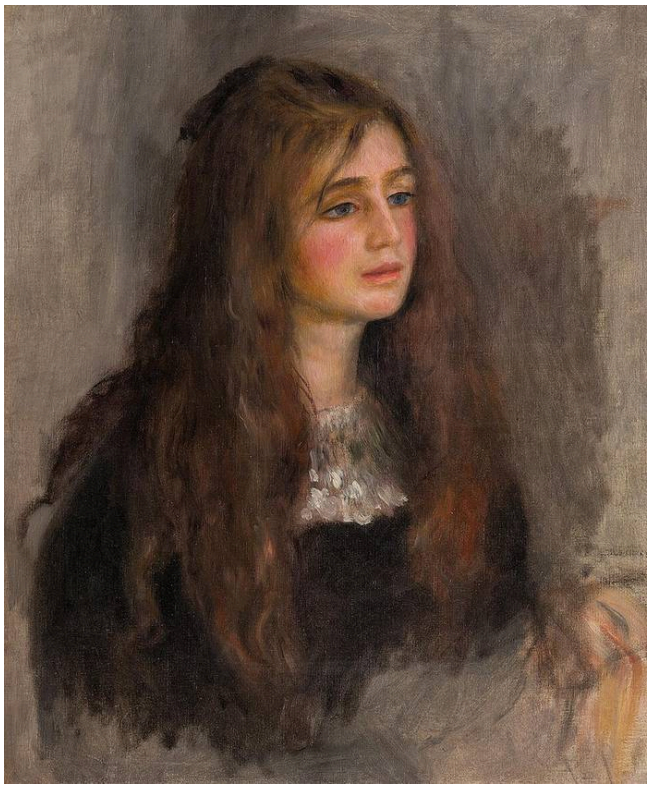
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 6086

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Portrait of Julie Manet

Pierre-Auguste Renoir

1894 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Pierre-Auguste Renoir. Portrait de Julie Manet. Image credit: Pierre-Auguste Renoir; musée Marmottan-Monet [1]. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Auguste_Renoir_-_Portrait_de_Julie_Manet_-_Mus%C3%A9e_Marmottan-Monet.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

Long hair and a dark dress give the portrait a settled lower structure, while the slight turn of the face keeps it from becoming symmetrically frontal. The softly worked background supplies little competing information. The sitter's individuality is carried through this direction of attention, not through a symbolic object added beside her.

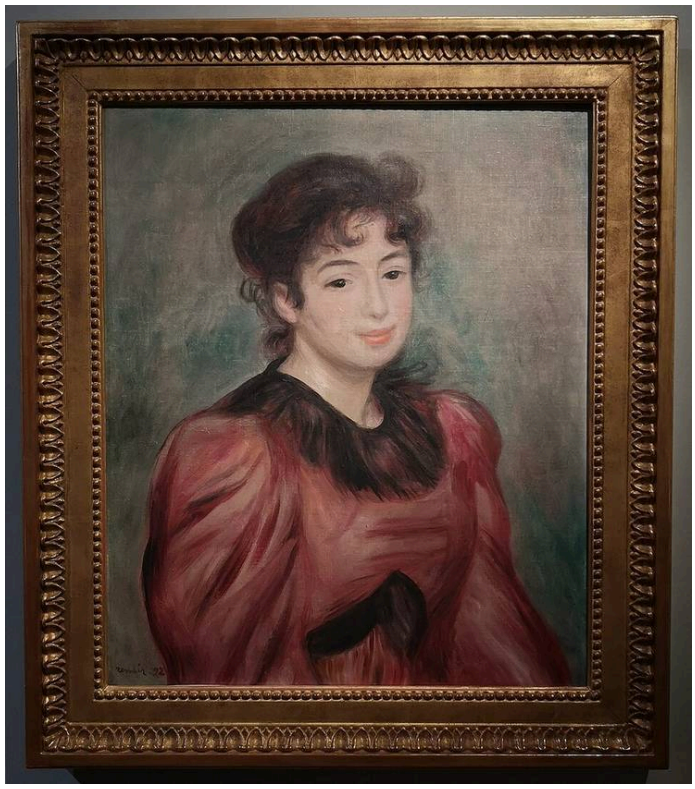
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 6092

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Mademoiselle Victorine de Bellio

Pierre-Auguste Renoir

1892 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Pierre-Auguste Renoir. Portrait de Mademoiselle Victorine de Bellio. Image credit: Pierre-Auguste Renoir; Source credit: Gianluca T.. CC BY-SA 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0). Proportional resize and JPEG compression; full source frame retained. · CC BY-SA 4.0

The red blouse establishes the portrait's largest warm area. Above it, the face is built from smaller and softer changes, so it remains distinct without needing an equally sharp division at every edge. The pale background gives those differences room, keeping the clothing prominent without allowing it to replace the sitter.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 4024

15 / 20

Spring near Paris: Apple Trees in Blossom

Alfred Sisley

1879 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Alfred Sisley. Printemps aux environs de Paris. Pommiers en fleurs. Image credit: Alfred Sisley; musée Marmottan-Monet [1]. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Alfred_Sisley_-_Printemps_aux_environs_de_Paris,_pommiers_en_fleurs_-_Mus%C3%A9e_Marmottan-Monet.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The flowering trees repeat across grass and cultivated ground, providing a structure that the pale blossoms partly dissolve. Behind them, the darker hill keeps the light growth from merging with the whole distance. Spring becomes visible through a change in familiar tree forms, rather than through an added seasonal anecdote.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 4025

16 / 20

Volterra: Road Descending from the Town

Jean-Baptiste-Camille Corot

c. 1834 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Jean-Baptiste-Camille Corot. Volterra. Route descendant de la ville. Image credit: Jean-Baptiste Camille Corot; musée Marmottan-Monet [1]. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Jean_Baptiste_Camille_Corot_-_Volterra._Route_descendant_de_la_ville_-_Mus%C3%A9e_Marmottan-Monet.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The road's curve connects the figure and nearer trees to the more distant town. Simple tonal changes and overlapping ground are enough to establish depth along that route. The small person measures the setting without supplying a separate drama; movement through the place already gives the view a useful direction.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 6505

17 / 20

Indian Summer near Moret-sur-Loing

Alfred Sisley

1891 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Alfred Sisley. Été de la Saint-Martin, environs de Moret-sur-Loing. Image credit: Alfred Sisley; Source credit: Gianluca T.. CC BY-SA 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0). Proportional resize and JPEG compression; full source frame retained. · CC BY-SA 4.0

Tall trees divide the landscape into narrow intervals beside the watercourse. Warm foliage catches attention against cooler areas farther away, making seasonal colour a means of separating distance. The repeated uprights remain important even where their leaves vary, holding together a view that could otherwise fragment into patches of warmth.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: D.2018.1.12

18 / 20

At the Ball

Berthe Morisot

1875 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Berthe Morisot. Au bal. Image credit: Berthe Morisot; https://www.marmottan.fr/wp-content/themes/marmottan2019/collection/full/4020.jpg. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Au_bal,_par_Berthe_Morisot.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The open fan both belongs to the sitter and partly screens her. Its spread alters the portrait's outline, drawing attention toward the face while also interrupting access to it. Pale dress and skin remain distinct amid darker hair and plants. An ordinary accessory becomes an active part of how the person is presented.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 4020

19 / 20

The Pont de l'Europe, Gare Saint-Lazare

Claude Monet

1877 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Claude Monet. Le pont de l'Europe. Gare Saint-Lazare.. Image credit: Claude Monet; Own work. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Claude_Monet,_1877,_Pont_de_l%27Europe_(cropped).jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

Iron structures give the station a firm framework, then steam makes parts of it difficult to see. The diagonal bridge remains legible above the changing white masses. Industry and atmosphere are inseparable subjects here: the machines produce some of the very air through which their architecture must be painted.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 4015

20 / 20

Arm of the Seine near Giverny, Sunrise

Claude Monet

1897 · Oil on canvas · Musée Marmottan Monet



Claude Monet. Bras de Seine près de Giverny, soleil levant. Image credit: Claude Monet; musée Marmottan-Monet [1]. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Claude_Monet_-_Bras_de_Seine_pr%C3%A8s_de_Giverny,_soleil_levant_-_Mus%C3%A9e_Marmottan-Monet.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The banks and their reflections approach one another in blue and violet, leaving a pale opening as the river's clearest indication. Water is understood partly through the space the trees do not occupy. The difficulty of locating a firm boundary gives the scene continuity without turning it into a uniformly undifferentiated surface.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: D.11-1993

Start with a boundary

Choose one edge—a face against a hat, steam against iron or a tree against its reflection—and follow where it becomes clear or uncertain. That comparison works across several artists without implying identical methods. Check the museum's current display and loans before planning a visit around a particular painting.

Further reading

Impressionism: A Centenary Exhibition

Anne Dayez, Michel Hoog and Charles S. Moffett · Read online or download · English

Impressionism: A Centenary Exhibition supplies historical context for Monet, Morisot, Renoir and Sisley. Use its entries to compare their subjects and methods rather than treating Impressionism as one uniform style.

Museum website · Official collection guide

Sources and visitor information checked: 2026-10-12

Artline · Musée Marmottan Monet: Masterpieces